

BIGGEST MYTHS OF AI

Elon Musk is terrified about humanity creating sentient AI like in the Terminator and The Matrix movies. But surely it's an overreaction? What other myths exist about AI? And what are our biggest hopes on AI's promises? We asked these questions to actual AI experts, and this is how they responded.

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"The notion that AI will be so smart that it will take over our lives. At the end of the day, AI is just a tool. Pretty much like the shovel or kitchen knife, it can be used both in good ways and bad ways. But what we shouldn't forget is that the responsibility will always be with humans. So if an AI goes wrong, we have to find the people behind it and punish them, and not necessarily the technology on the front."

– **SEBASTIAN THRUN**, CEO of Kitty Hawk Corporation, and chairman and co-founder of Udacity. He's a German-American computer scientist.



"Most people have no idea about the importance of the current exponential growth in technology. Forget about smart AI, there's this idea that we're already in the fourth industrial revolution, which I think is absolutely not true – we aren't even in the subset of an industrial revolution. What we're at the beginning of is in fact the information revolution, which started around the 1960s, and it's going to have a bigger impact than the agricultural or the industrial revolution."

– **CALUM CHACE**, Speaker, Best-selling author of *Surviving AI* and *The Economic Singularity*

"The biggest myth about AI is that it's a black box – it's not. No matter how sophisticated the AI algorithm designs, they can be changed, adjusted and continuously refined. So AI isn't something that we can't do anything about, because we retain control on how we shape its future."

– **MARIAGRAZIA SQUICCIARINI**, Chief of Executive Office and Director a.i., UNESCO



"Biggest myth about AI is that it's dangerous and it's surpassing humans and human intelligence. Don't get me wrong, AI can outperform in many human tasks like image, text and voice recognition, so in these assistive technologies AI will be a great helper to humankind. AI will never be dangerous, I don't think it will ever acquire consciousness, and malevolent use of AI will be only controlled or limited by the human mind."

– **ALEX ZHAVORONKOV**, Founder and CEO, Insilico Medicine

"AI is going to take away all of our jobs, AI is dangerous, and that AI wouldn't help humanity to have a better life!"

– **MAJID ALSHEHRY**, Official Spokesperson, Saudi Data and Artificial Intelligence Authority



"Today, there's a lot of hype around AI, and a lot of solutions marketed as AI are actually quite simple linear regression models and scripts. Apart from a tiny core of impressive AI out there, but a lot of it is just hype and marketing and really not all that exciting, to be honest."

– **GEIR ENGDAHL**, CTO and Co-Founder of Cognite

"You have to be good in math to excel at AI, or you need to be amazing in science to master the nuances of AI. If AI learning models are designed intelligently, with intuitive use at its very core, then I think everyone can be a potential expert at learning how to apply AI across different fields."

– **HEIDI SAMPANG**, MD, Philippines Flying Labs

